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# The Naga Tribes of Manipur: Tangkhul Sections

TITLE: The Naga Tribes of Manipur: Tangkhul Sections
Identifier: BK-ARCH-003
Level: Academic / Historical | Subject: Ethnography, Linguistics and Customary Law
Publisher: Macmillan and Co., Limited, London (1911)
Language: Tangkhul (Ukhrul / Raphei / Kamo)
Preservation Archive: Tangkhul Language Library Digital Repository

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# Preface & Archival Information

The Naga Tribes of Manipur (Tangkhul Sections) by T. C. Hodson, late Assistant Political Agent in Manipur and Superintendent of the State (Macmillan and Co., Limited, London, 1911). Presents the authoritative historical and ethnographic documentation of the Tangkhul Nagas, their habitat, social organization, village headmanship, folktales, ballads, and linguistic survey.

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# Chapter 1: Habitat, Geography & Tribal Divisions

## CHAPTER 1: HABITAT, GEOGRAPHY & TRIBAL DIVISIONS

Summary: Geographical territory and four subdivisions: Raphei, Kathur, Kamo, and Kharao.

## TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Tangkhul miyur hi Manipur wui kaphung zanshorli pamda kaphung khangacheo eina ngashitna. Ayur khani eina mati leiyi: Raphei (Northern Tangkhuls), Kathur (Central Tangkhuls around Ukhrul), Kamo (Southern Tangkhuls bordering Maring territory), and Kharao (Western Tangkhuls facing the valley). Ukhrul kaphung hi phungreitang sada kaphung khangateiwui tui ngazekpam thada leiyi.

## ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

The Tangkhuls occupy the mountain tracts east of the valley of Manipur. They are grouped into four main territorial sections: Raphei in the north, Kathur in the centre around Ukhrul and Hungpung, Kamo in the south, and Kharao in the west. Ukhrul serves as the recognized linguistic standard among all regional dialects.

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# Chapter 1 Exercises & Vocabulary

## CHAPTER 1 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

### VOCABULARY:

* raphei (noun): northern Tangkhul area
  Example: Raphei ramli.
* kathur (noun): central Tangkhul area
  Example: Kathur Ukhrul.
* kamo (noun): southern Tangkhul area
  Example: Kamoram khava.
* kharao (noun): western Tangkhul area
  Example: Kharao ngaleili.

### GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Locative case marker -li attached to geographical names.
- Directional nominalization: zanshor (east), zantung (west).

### REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What are the four historical subdivisions of the Tangkhul territory?
? Why was Ukhrul selected as the central standard by early linguists?

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# Chapter 2: Tangkhul Linguistic Classification & Dialects

## CHAPTER 2: TANGKHUL LINGUISTIC CLASSIFICATION & DIALECTS

Summary: Agglutinative morphology, vowel length contrasts, and Tibeto-Burman affiliations.

## TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Tangkhul language exhibits agglutinative morphology with dominant prefix ka- forming adjectives and infinitives. Case relationships are indicated by postpositional affixes: -na (agentive), -li (dative/locative), -wui (genitive). Vowel length contrasts: ’sa’ (to do) vs ’sa’ (animal/flesh); ’mik’ (eye) vs ’mei’ (fire).

## ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Linguistic features of Tangkhul: Extensive use of prefixes and suffixes. Nominal and adjectival derivation through prefix ka-. Case markers function as postpositional clitics. Phonemic vowel length distinguishes essential vocabulary pairs.

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# Chapter 2 Exercises & Vocabulary

## CHAPTER 2 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

### VOCABULARY:

* shiyan (noun): linguistic standard, rule
  Example: Shiyan kashak.
* kakhalat (noun): meaning, pronunciation
  Example: Kakhalat kashak.
* tuiyur (noun): dialect, language branch
  Example: Tuiyur ngateina.

### GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Phonemic vowel length contrasts.
- Agglutinative affix ordering in verbal complexes.

### REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Give two examples of minimal vowel length pairs in Tangkhul.

? Which prefix is predominantly used to form infinitives?

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# Chapter 3: Village Organization & The Awunga (Headman)

## CHAPTER 3: VILLAGE ORGANIZATION & THE AWUNGA (HEADMAN)

Summary: Hereditary chieftainship (Awunga), the village council (Hangva), and clan clans (Shangnao).

## TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Khaung kachida Awunga akha leiyi; Awunga hi shimkhurwui mathun eina ngashitna. Hangva council eina ngasoda ram shiyan kashak saikora ngazekseri. Shangnao kachida paman kathana mi akhakhana hangvali zangda khaungwui ot ngazeka.

## ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Every Tangkhul village is an autonomous democratic unit under a hereditary chief called the Awunga. The Awunga rules in consultation with the village council (Hangva), comprised of representatives from each clan (Shangnao), managing village land, disputes, and seasonal festivals.

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# Chapter 3 Exercises & Vocabulary

## CHAPTER 3 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

## VOCABULARY:

* awunga (noun): village chief, king
  Example: Awunga shimkhur.
* hangva (noun): council of elders
  Example: Hangvali zangda.
* shangnao (noun): clan lineage
  Example: Shangnao kachida.

## GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Honorific register associated with the Awunga.
- Reciprocal verbal affix ngazor / ngazek.

## REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What is the role of the Hangva in village governance?

? How is the position of Awunga inherited?

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# Chapter 4: Traditional Laws, Land Tenure & Feasts of Merit

## CHAPTER 4: TRADITIONAL LAWS, LAND TENURE & FEASTS OF MERIT

Summary: Maran (Feasts of Merit), Tarung monuments, and terraced land rights.

## TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Maran kashak hi Tangkhul ngashanli khamataiya otsak akhana. Tarung thingrei vakhang eina shimli shona. Seichang kala hok kachung khami eina ramnaoli shongza kashak saikora ngashitna. Lungto kala lungchan shoda awo-ayiwui machut saikora chimiksho chitheiya.

## ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

The Feasts of Merit (Maran) represent the summit of customary social achievement. The celebrant earns the right to erect the carved Tarung monument post before his house. Mithuns and cattle are slaughtered to feast the entire community, and megalithic stone platforms are built.

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# Chapter 4 Exercises & Vocabulary

## CHAPTER 4 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

## VOCABULARY:

* maran (noun): feast of merit
  Example: Maran kashak.
* tarung (noun): forked monument post
  Example: Tarung shona.
* seichang (noun): mithun (Bos frontalis)
  Example: Seichang kashai.

## GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Instrumental clitic -eina in monument dragging chants.
- Nominal compounds combining animal terms and festive rites.

## REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What privileges does a celebrant gain by performing Maran?

? Describe the physical appearance and cultural meaning of the Tarung.

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# Chapter 5: Tangkhul Folktales: Origin of the Species & Animals

## CHAPTER 5: TANGKHUL FOLKTALES: ORIGIN OF THE SPECIES & ANIMALS

Summary: Mythological origin legends and the ancient brotherhood of hill and valley.

## TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Awo-ayiwui khararchanli: 'Avah Samsokli tungthuiya, Makungana ili phungtung.' Chinaoni khani: kakhara a kaphungli leiyi, kakhanao a ngaleili vaipama. Meitei eina Tangkhul chinaoni thada kum kachida Mera Hou Chongba phanitli leikashi chithei ngaroka.

## ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Tangkhul mythology traces common origins from Samsok in the eastern hills. Tradition holds that two brothers parted ways: the elder brother settled in the misty Tangkhul heights, while the younger brother cultivated the fertile valley, establishing a bond renewed at the annual Mera festival.

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# Chapter 5 Exercises & Vocabulary

## CHAPTER 5 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

## VOCABULARY:

* khararchan (noun): ancestral folklore
  Example: Awo-ayiwui khararchan.
* samsok (proper): ancient migration staging ground
  Example: Samsokli tungthuiya.
* chinaoni (noun): brothers, siblings
  Example: Chinaoni khani.

## GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Comparative conjunction thada (like, in the manner of).
- Ablative suffix -eina in origin narratives.

## REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What does the Samsok migration legend signify?

? How is the kinship between Meiteis and Tangkhuls celebrated traditionally?

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# Chapter 6: Traditional Tangkhul Ballads & Folk Poetry

## CHAPTER 6: TRADITIONAL TANGKHUL BALLADS & FOLK POETRY

Summary: The epic ballad of Shimreishang and Maitonphi, and heroic martial poetry.

## TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Shimreishang eina Maitonphiwui leikashiyi Tangkhul thotchanli kaphapamei laana. ’Avayo avayo, makhamalu Maitonphili rasha saka; sakhangaiye Maitonphi kharam thuihaowa.’ Kazeiramli anili ngazipda kumching kumching leikashi ngazipsera.

## ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

The tragic romance of Shimreishang and Maitonphi is the most famous epic ballad of the Tangkhuls. Forced apart by parental opposition and village taboos, their spirits are finally united in Kazeiram, the tranquil land of the departed where true lovers dwell forever.

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# Chapter 6 Exercises & Vocabulary

## CHAPTER 6 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

## VOCABULARY:

* leishat laa (noun): love song, romantic ballad
  Example: Leishat laa sa.
* kazeiram (noun): land of the dead
  Example: Kazeiramli ngazipra.
* haolaa (noun): traditional folk song
  Example: Haolaa sakasa.

## GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Antiphonal dialogue structure in romantic verse.
- Poetic vocabulary substitutions in folk metrics.

## REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Why is the story of Shimreishang and Maitonphi significant in Tangkhul literature?
? What is Kazeiram in traditional Tangkhul eschatology?

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# Chapter 7: Comparative Vocabulary & Dialectal Specimen

## CHAPTER 7: COMPARATIVE VOCABULARY & DIALECTAL SPECIMEN

Summary: Diagnostic 100-word vocabulary, kinship terminology, and dialectal correspondences.

## TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

1. Mi (Man) 2. Akui (Head) 3. Sam (Hair) 4. Mik (Eye) 5. Khana (Ear) 6. Khamasung (Nose) 7. Khamor (Mouth) 8. Ha (Tooth) 9. Pang (Hand) 10. Phei (Foot) 11. Zingsho (Sun) 12. Kachang (Moon) 13. Sirak (Star) 14. Mei (Fire) 15. Tara (Water) 16. Shim (House) 17. Si (Dog) 18. Vana (Bird) 19. Khai (Fish) 20. Thing (Tree). Numerals: akha (1), khani (2), kathum (3), mati (4), phanga (5), tharuk (6), shini (7), chishat (8), chiko (9), thara (10).

## ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Standard lexical list compiled by T. C. Hodson illustrating anatomical nouns, celestial bodies, faunal terms, cardinal numerals 1-10, and cross-dialectal phonetic correspondences between Ukhrul (Kathur), Raphei (Northern), and Kamo (Southern) varieties.

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# Chapter 7 (Continued)

## CHAPTER 7: READING CONTINUATION (PAGE 17)

## TANGKHUL TEXT (CONTINUED):

1. Mi (Man) 2. Akui (Head) 3. Sam (Hair) 4. Mik (Eye) 5. Khana (Ear) 6. Khamasung (Nose) 7. Khamor (Mouth) 8. Ha (Tooth) 9. Pang (Hand) 10. Phei (Foot) 11. Zingsho (Sun) 12. Kachang (Moon) 13. Sirak (Star) 14. Mei (Fire) 15. Tara (Water) 16. Shim (House) 17. Si (Dog) 18. Vana (Bird) 19. Khai (Fish) 20. Thing (Tree). Numerals: akha (1), khani (2), kathum (3), mati (4), phanga (5), tharuk (6), shini (7), chishat (8), chiko (9), thara (10).

## ENGLISH TRANSLATION (CONTINUED):

Standard lexical list compiled by T. C. Hodson illustrating anatomical nouns, celestial bodies, faunal terms, cardinal numerals 1-10, and cross-dialectal phonetic correspondences between Ukhrul (Kathur), Raphei (Northern), and Kamo (Southern) varieties.

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# Chapter 7 Exercises & Vocabulary

## CHAPTER 7 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

### VOCABULARY:

* akui (noun): head
  Example: Akui kakhanang.
* mik (noun): eye
  Example: Mik eina theila.
* pang (noun): hand
  Example: Pang eina kasa.
* tara (noun): water
  Example: Tara kashing.

### GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Base-10 decimal numeral system.
- Systematic sound shifts across regional varieties.

### REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Count from 1 to 10 in Tangkhul.
? Identify three anatomical terms that feature prefix a-.

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# Comprehensive Vocabulary Glossary

## COMPREHENSIVE BOOK GLOSSARY (TUIWON SHIYAN):

raphei [noun]: northern Tangkhul area
kathur [noun]: central Tangkhul area
kamo [noun]: southern Tangkhul area
kharao [noun]: western Tangkhul area
shiyan [noun]: linguistic standard, rule
kakhalat [noun]: meaning, pronunciation
tuiyur [noun]: dialect, language branch
awunga [noun]: village chief, king
hangva [noun]: council of elders
shangnao [noun]: clan lineage
maran [noun]: feast of merit
tarung [noun]: forked monument post
seichang [noun]: mithun (Bos frontalis)
khararchan [noun]: ancestral folklore
samsok [proper]: ancient migration staging ground
chinaoni [noun]: brothers, siblings
leishat laa [noun]: love song, romantic ballad
kazeiram [noun]: land of the dead
haolaa [noun]: traditional folk song
akui [noun]: head
mik [noun]: eye
pang [noun]: hand
tara [noun]: water

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# Colophon & Archival Preservation Notice

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Book ID: BK-ARCH-003
Title: The Naga Tribes of Manipur: Tangkhul Sections
Publisher: Macmillan and Co., Limited, London
Publication Year: 1911
Dialect Variety: Ukhrul / Raphei / Kamo
Total Digital Pages: 20
Total Chapters: 7
Total Words Indexed: 573

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